NCCA ENTERTAINMENT PRESENTS · FEATURE FILM PITCH · NETFLIX

THE GHOSTMAKER

Every lie she ever told had her name on it.

GENRE ESPIONAGE THRILLER **FORMAT** FEATURE, APPROX. 100 MIN **RATING** R

LANGUAGES ENGLISH, ARABIC, FRENCH **DRAFT** 5, SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

> A CIA operative who forges evidence for a living is framed for a massacre by the man who built her memories. To stop his next attack and save the sister she can't remember, she must expose the program, and confess to every lie she ever planted.

SYNOPSIS

Mara Lennox manufactures truth. Her forged evidence is so clean it becomes history: a briefcase in Prague, a ledger in Geneva, a server nobody will ever question. Then an airstrike on an aid convoy kills thirty-one children, and the targeting data carries her signature.

Hunted across Paris by a private army, Mara joins forces with Elena Vasquez, a journalist whose career was destroyed by fabricated evidence, and follows her own stolen code to a scientist hiding at a frozen Alpine lake. There she learns the truth. She was never Mara. She is Subject 17 of a black program that took refugee children from a camp in Lebanon and wrote over who they were. The girl who has shadowed her since Prague is her sister, the first subject whose mind refused to forget.

The program's architect, David Reeves, needs one thing before the Geneva arms treaty vote on Sunday morning: Mara's live signature on a final attack. To stop him, she has to release an archive that frees every subject and convicts her of everything she has done. The price is the one memory she has left.

WHY NETFLIX

A female-led global action thriller in the lane of The Old Guard, Extraction and Heart of Stone, built on a hook that plays in any language: in a world of deepfakes and forged records, the most dangerous weapon is a real signature.

COMPARABLES

The Bourne Identity meets The Old Guard, with the emotional core of Capernaum.

WORLD

Prague, Paris, Geneva, the Swiss Alps and the Jura. Cold, precise, lived-in European tradecraft.

FRANCHISE

Seventeen erased subjects get their names back at the end of the film. Every one of them is a story. Built for a sequel or a limited series.

PRINCIPAL CHARACTERS

MARA LENNOX / LAYLA HADDAD, 28. The forger who finds out she was forged.

DAVID REEVES, 40s. The architect. Turned his grief into a machine.

MARCUS ROTH, 40s. CIA counterintelligence. Saw the order and went for coffee.

ZOE / NOOR HADDAD, 15. Her sister. The subject who remembered everything.

ELENA VASQUEZ, 30s. Journalist. Hunting the people who took her brother.

DEPUTY DIRECTOR VOSS, 50s. Signed the program. Has carried the letter for three years.

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CAST SUGGESTIONS

> **Casting principle.** Mara and Zoe are Syrian sisters taken from a camp in Lebanon. Both roles should go to actors of Levantine heritage who can carry scenes in Arabic. Authenticity in these two roles is the film's credibility with a global audience. The names below are creative targets only; availability and interest have not been checked.

MARA / LAYLA

28. Lead. Physical, controlled, quietly funny. Carries the action and the final interview.

Manal Issa
THE SWIMMERS
Lebanese-French. Intense physical presence, fluent in Arabic and French. Top authenticity choice.

Nathalie Issa
THE SWIMMERS
Lebanese. Played a Syrian refugee athlete for Netflix. A proven fit with the platform and a breakout-ready lead.

Sofia Boutella
ATOMIC BLONDE, REBEL MOON
Algerian-French. A global action name with Netflix history. Would mean aging the role into her thirties.

ZOE / NOOR

15. Guarded, blunt, brilliant. Leads a network of escaped subjects.

Open search
RECOMMENDED
A discovery cast from Arabic-speaking communities in Paris, Berlin, Amman and Beirut, following the approach that found the young cast of Capernaum. A newcomer against an established Mara is the right balance.

DAVID REEVES

40s. Antagonist. Elegant, intimate, grieving. Menace through tenderness.

Dan Stevens
THE GUEST, LEGION
Charm that turns cold in a single look. Has played exactly this kind of polished menace.

Rupert Friend
HOMELAND
Intelligence tradecraft credibility and real vulnerability for the Homs flashback.

Matthew Goode
STOKER, THE CROWN
Refined and unreadable. The orange-peeling scene in his hands would be quietly terrifying.

ELENA VASQUEZ

30s. Co-lead. Journalist with nothing left but the story and her brother.

Adria Arjona
ANDOR, HIT MAN
Warmth, wit and grit. Holds her own opposite a physical lead.

Úrsula Corberó
MONEY HEIST
One of Netflix's biggest international stars. Strong pull in Spain and Latin America.

Melissa Barrera
IN THE HEIGHTS, SCREAM
Emotional openness for the hostel and server-core scenes.

CAST SUGGESTIONS

MARCUS ROTH

40s. CIA counterintelligence. The conscience of the institution, and its guilt.

Brian Tyree Henry ATLANTA, BULLET TRAIN	Stillness and decency under pressure. The Senate testimony would land.
Jesse Plemons CIVIL WAR	Plays careful men who notice everything. Ideal for the coffee confession.
Sterling K. Brown THIS IS US, PARADISE	Authority with a moral center. A strong name for the ensemble.

DEPUTY DIRECTOR VOSS

50s. Signed the program eleven years ago. Finally says no.

Robin Wright HOUSE OF CARDS	Netflix history and icy institutional power.
Laura Linney OZARK	Shows compromise and conscience at the same time.
Regina King WATCHMEN	Command presence. Her "No" to the Director would be a trailer moment.

DR. JAMES KESSLER

Late 60s. The scientist who built it and never went to the camp.

Stellan Skarsgård ANDOR, CHERNOBYL	Guilt worn down to the bone. Two scenes that would stay with an audience.
Christoph Waltz INGLOURIOUS BASTERDS	Precision and a dry wit for the "uncooperative" line.
Ulrich Thomsen THE CELEBRATION, BANSHEE	European authenticity and quiet weight.

SUPPORTING

Smaller roles with real moments.

Marco Vasquez ELENA'S BROTHER	Miguel Bernardeau or Arón Piper (Élite). Netflix-grown Spanish talent for the "I had a cat" scene.
Tomas / Chidi ESCAPED SUBJECT	Toheeb Jimoh (Ted Lasso), or a Nigerian discovery cast. His real name is the film's quiet gut-punch.
Collier MARA'S FORMER HANDLER	Tobias Menzies (The Crown) or Richard Armitage (Fool Me Once).
Dmitri Volkov OLIGARCH	Alexei Serebryakov (Leviathan) or Yuri Kolokolnikov. Two scenes, one photograph, a lot of weight.